

Eyes Practice Sheet

Learn to draw eyes by seeing the shapes first.

Don't try to finish this perfectly in one sitting. Use it as practice.

Big shapes → Medium shapes → Small shapes → Details

How to use this worksheet

1. **Trace the construction first.** Follow the simplified shapes and the tilt of the corners before you chase eyelashes.
2. **Recreate it beside the guide.** Draw the same eye without tracing. Check angle and proportion before you shade.
3. **Take it to a new face.** Find another reference and see whether you can recognise the same shapes yourself.

The important part isn't producing one perfect eye. It's training your brain to notice these things without needing someone to point them out.

Guide



A finished eye from one of my portraits.

Your turn

Draw the big shapes here

Start with angle, shapes and proportion

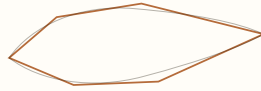
Most "detail problems" actually started here. Get this right before the iris, lashes or shading.

01 – Look at the angle first



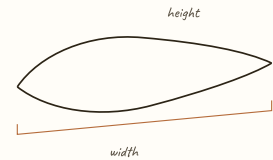
Is one corner higher than the other?
Draw what you see, not the symbol of
an eye.

02 – Simplify into shapes



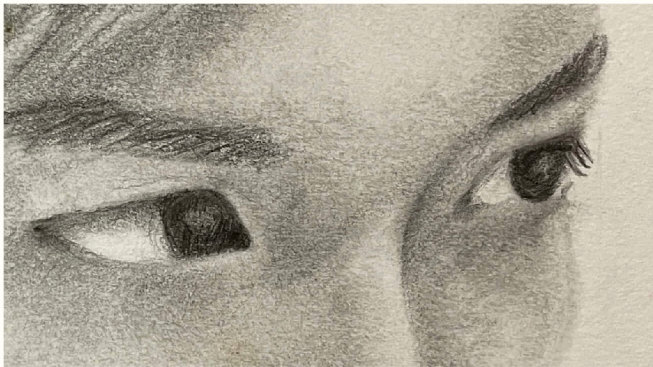
Look for the straight and angled lines
hidden inside the curves. Don't make it
beautiful yet.

03 – Check the proportions



Compare width, height and the
corners. Small differences matter a lot
in a portrait.

Practice: copy the tilt and the polygon of this eye, then check the width against the height.

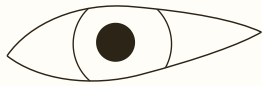


Angle + polygon

Iris, eyelids, then light

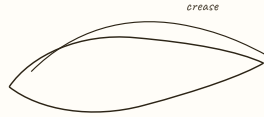
Only add these after the outside structure feels right. Structure first. Detail last.

04 – Iris and pupil



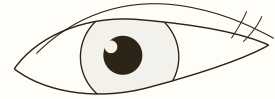
Don't draw a full circle floating inside the eye. The lids overlap the iris.

05 – Eyelids



The lid isn't just another line. Notice distance to the crease, and how age changes the folds.

06 – Light and shadow



Some edges are sharp. Most are softer than you think. Lashes come last.

Practice: place the iris under the lids, then add the crease. Leave lashes until the end.



Iris + lids + light

Trace the faint eye, then draw it beside

Print this page and draw over the light image first. Then try the same eye in the empty box without tracing.

Trace



Copy (no tracing)



Trace



Copy (no tracing)



Trace



Copy (no tracing)



Practice · your own reference

Now try it on a new face

Pick a photo. Before you draw, ask: what is the tilt? What polygon is hiding in the curve? How much of the iris is actually visible?

Construction

Angle · polygon · proportion

Form

Iris · lids · light

A slower pass — structure first, detail last

If this way of looking helped something click, I go much deeper into the rest of the face in **PlayingWithPencil: The Portrait Sketching Masterclass** — learn.playingwithpencil.art/beg-course

I'm Jeff. Portrait drawing isn't simply talent. A lot of it is learning how to observe — then practising that process until it becomes instinctive.